

New Ground: Pressure Builds

新的起点：压力上升

Theme: 大学生活与个人成长 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The second week brought the first real pressure. Maya asked **why** the project had to grow, and Lin could not answer. A new **opportunity** appeared: the student union offered a suitable room and a camera, but only if the group promised more work than they could **sustain**. “We cannot **afford** to **rely** on a **favor**,” Maya said. “We need an **honest** system, not a kind one.” She was equally tired; to her **delight** the union also sent **digestive** biscuits for the folk on the night shift.

Their **confidence** was smaller than their ambition. Lin tried to **assure** her that **faith** in a good idea would be enough, but he did not sound **confident**, and she was too tired to cheer him. “I am **sad**,” she admitted, “not discouraged.” The distinction mattered: discouragement ends work, and sadness only slows it. An **envious** volunteer said the same thing in a less **merciful** tone, and Maya answered with an **appreciative** nod. They had to evaluate the plan again that night.

Money was the next **rival**. A **discount** on printing expired, and the sum looked like **rubbish** against their budget. A woman from the union called their plan **encouraging** and then asked for a guarantee they could not give. “Do not **exploit** goodwill,” she said. “It will not **renew** itself.” Her manner was **gracious**, and her warning gave Maya a small **boost** of **admiration** for the project’s own **kindness**. The union called its own new logo **sexy**; Maya called it a distraction. Regarding the money, she wrote, the project was already behind.

Two volunteers began to **dislike** the crowded evenings. Obviously the evenings were too long. They were **alike** in one way only: neither could be relied on after midnight, and both often said so. Their reasons did not **resemble** each other. The group’s **accord** held, though a **wary** silence crept in. Lin was **grateful** for the **honest** statement and sorry for its cause. A **lonely** walk home along the river made the choice clearer, not easier. “Give me one more week,” he said again.

Spring arrived late and **snowy**. In an **appealing**, **hospitable** voice, Professor Zhao reminded them that a project ripens like fruit: slowly, and only if someone waters it. His **disapproval** of their rush was gentle but complete, and the **sorrowful** faces in the room told him it had landed. “You are **mistaken** about the cost,” he said. “The goal is not.” They agreed to re-evaluate the plan, **recycle** the wasted printing, and describe their limits to every willing volunteer. Otherwise the next version would fail where this one did, and no photo shoot would hide it. The consent form, they decided, was their only real asset.

中文翻译

第二周带来了第一次真正的压力。曼雅问这个项目为什么必须扩张，林伟答不上来。同一天早上出现了一个新机会：学生会愿意提供一间合适的房间和一台相机，但前提是小组承诺做超出他们承受能力的工作。“我们承担不起靠人情办事的代价，”曼雅说，“我们需要一个诚实的系统，而不是一个善良的系统。”她同样疲惫，而让她高兴的是，学生会还给上夜班的普通人送去了一盘消化饼干。

他们的信心小于他们的雄心。林伟试图向她保证：只要对一个好想法有信心就够了；但他听起来并不自信，而她也累得没力气鼓励他。“我很难过，”她承认，“但不是气馁。”这个区别很重要：气馁会终止工作，难过只会让它变慢。一位心怀嫉妒的志愿者用不那么慈悲的口气说了同样的话，曼雅则以感激的点头回应。那天晚上他们不得不再次评估这份计划。

钱是下一个对手。印刷折扣到期，那笔钱在预算面前看起来像垃圾。学生会的一位女士称他们的方案令人鼓舞，随后又要求一个他们给不出来的保证。“不要滥用善意，”她说，“它不会自行更新。”她的举止很亲切，而她这句警告让曼雅对这个项目自身的善意多了一份敬意。学生会说自己的新标志很性感；曼雅说那只是干扰。关于钱，她写道，项目已经落后了。

两名志愿者开始厌恶拥挤的夜晚。显然这些夜晚太长了。他们只有一个共同点：午夜之后谁都靠不住，而两人也常常这么说。他们的理由彼此并不相似。小组的共识还在，尽管一种警惕的沉默慢慢渗了进来。林伟感激那句诚实的话，也为它的起因感到抱歉。沿着河边独自走回家的路并没有让选择更容易，只是让它更清楚。“再给我一周，”他又说了一遍。

春天来得晚，还下着雪。赵教授用动人而好客的语气提醒他们：项目像果实一样成熟——很慢，而且只有有人浇水才行。他们对他们急躁的不赞成温和却彻底，屋里那些悲伤的脸说明这话已经落地。“你们弄错的不是目标，”他说，“而是代价。”他们同意重新评估计划、回收浪费的印刷品，并向每一位愿意听的志愿者说明自己的限度。否则下一个版本会在这个版本失败的地方原样失败，而再多的拍照也掩盖不了。他们认定，同意书是他们唯一真正的资产。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
why hwai POS: adv	adv. 为什么; n. 原因, 理由 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cause or intention underlying an action or situation, especially in the phrase `the whys and wherefore`...
opportunity ˌope'tju:niti POS: n	n. 机会, 时机 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a possibility due to a favorable combination of circumstances
encourage in'kʌrɪdʒ POS: vt	vt. 鼓励, 支持, 激励; [法] 怂恿, 煽动, 助长 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. inspire with confidence; give hope or courage to; v. spur on
faith feɪθ POS: n	n. 信心, 信任, 忠实, 保证; [法] 信任, 信仰, 信念 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. complete confidence in a person or plan etc; n. loyalty or allegiance to a cause or a person
confidence 'kɒnfɪdəns POS: n	n. 信心; [电] 可靠 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a feeling of trust (in someone or something); n. a state of confident hopefulness that events will be favor...
afford ə'fɔ:d POS: vt	vt. 买得起, 足以, 给予 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be able to spare or give up; v. have the financial means to do something or buy something; v. afford access...
rely ri'lai POS: vi	vi. 信赖, 依赖, 信任 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v have confidence or faith in
sad sæd POS: a	a. 忧愁的, 悲哀的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. experiencing or showing sorrow or unhappiness; s. of things that make you feel sad
favor 'feɪvə POS: n	n. 好意, 喜爱; vt. 赐予, 支持, 喜欢, 证实 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an act of gracious kindness; n. an advantage to the benefit of someone or something; n. an inclination to ap...
honest 'ɒnɪst POS: a	a. 诚实的, 坦直的, 可靠的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. not disposed to cheat or defraud; not deceptive or fraudulent; s. without dissimulation; frank; s. without p...
assure ə'ʃʊə POS: vt	vt. 保证, 使确信, 弄清楚, 担保; [法] 确信, 保证, 保障 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. inform positively and with certainty and confidence; v. assure somebody of the truth of something with the...
confident 'kɒnfɪdənt POS: a	a. 有信心的, 有把握的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having or marked by confidence or assurance; s. not liable to error in judgment or action
sustain sə'steɪn POS: vt	vt. 承受, 支持, 供养, 继续, 忍受, 蒙受, 证实, 准许; [电] 持续 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. supply with necessities and support; v. admit as valid
grateful 'ɡreɪtful POS: a	a. 感谢的, 感激的, 令人快意的, 受欢迎的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. feeling or showing gratitude; s. affording comfort or pleasure
exploit 'eksplɔɪt POS: n	n. 功绩, 勋绩; vt. 开发, 利用, 开拓, 剥削 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. use or manipulate to one's advantage; v. draw from; make good use of
resemble ri'zembl POS: vt	vt. 相似, 类似 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. appear like; be similar or bear a likeness to
rival 'raɪvl POS: n	n. 对手, 竞争者; a. 竞争的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the contestant you hope to defeat; v. be the rival of, be in competition with
discount 'diskaʊnt POS: n	n. 折扣, 贴现率; vt. 打折扣; vi. 贴现 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of reducing the selling price of merchandise; v. give a reduction in price on
rubbish 'rʌbɪʃ POS: n	n. 废物, 垃圾, 胡说 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. worthless material that is to be disposed of; v. attack strongly
encouraging in'kʌrɪdʒɪŋ POS: a	a. 鼓励的, 促进的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. giving courage or confidence or hope; s. furnishing support and encouragement
delight dɪ'lait POS: n	n. 高兴, 愉快; vt. 使高兴, 乐于; vi. 感到高兴(或愉快、快乐) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a feeling of extreme pleasure or satisfaction; v. take delight in
boost bu:st POS: n	n. 推进, 吹捧; vt. 推进, 提高, 宣扬, 促进 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of giving hope or support to someone; n. the act of giving a push; v. give a boost to; be beneficial...
lonely 'ləʊnli POS: a	a. 孤单的, 孤寂的, 荒凉的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. marked by dejection from being alone; s. devoid of creatures

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
discourage dis'kʌrɪdʒ POS: vt	vt. 使气馁, 阻碍 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. deprive of courage or hope; take away hope from; cause to feel discouraged
sexy 'seksi POS: a	a. 有性感的, 色情的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. marked by or tending to arouse sexual desire or interest
alike ə'laɪk POS: a	a. 相似的, 同样的; adv. 一样, 以同样的方式 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having the same or similar characteristics; r. equally; r. in a like manner
renew ri'nju: POS: vt	vt. 使更新, 使恢复, 复兴, 修补, 补充, 继续, 重订, 重申, 续借; vi. 更新, 重新开始 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. reestablish on a new, usually improved, basis or make new or like new; v. cause to appear in a new form
dislike dis'laɪk POS: n	n. 嫌恶; vt. 讨厌, 不喜欢 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a feeling of aversion or antipathy; v. have or feel a dislike or distaste for
accord ə'kɔ:d POS: n	n. 一致, 调和, 协定; vt. 给与, 使一致; vi. 相符合 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. concurrence of opinion; n. sympathetic compatibility; v. allow to have
admiration ,ædmə'reɪʃən POS: n	n. 赞赏, 钦佩, 引人赞赏的对象 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a feeling of delighted approval and liking; n. a favorable judgment
recycle ,ri:'saɪkl POS: vt	vt. 使再循环, 重新利用, 再制; n. 再循环 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to repeat a cycle; v. use again after processing
wary 'weəri POS: a	a. 谨慎的, 小心的, 机警的, 周到的, 唯恐的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. marked by keen caution and watchful prudence
kindness 'kaɪndnis POS: n	n. 仁慈, 亲切, 和蔼 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being warmhearted and considerate and humane and sympathetic; n. a kind act
appealing ə'pi:lɪŋ POS: a	a. 有感染力的, 动人的, 恳求的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. able to attract interest or draw favorable attention
gracious 'greɪʃəs POS: a	a. 亲切的, 慈善的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. characterized by charm, good taste, and generosity of spirit; s. disposed to bestow favors
disapproval ,dɪsə'pru:vəl POS: n	n. 不赞成 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a feeling of disliking something or what someone is doing; n. the expression of disapproval; n. the act of d...
mistaken mis'teɪkən POS: a	a. 犯错的, 错误的; mistake的过去分词 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. identify incorrectly; v. to make a mistake or be incorrect; s. wrong in e.g. opinion or judgment; s. arising from...
snowy 'snəʊi POS: a	a. 多雪的, 雪的, 被雪所覆盖着的, 下雪的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. marked by the presence of snow; s. covered with snow; s. of the white color of snow
digestive di'dʒestɪv POS: a	a. 消化的, 助消化的; n. 助消化药 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any substance that promotes digestion; a. relating to or having the power to cause or promote digestion
appreciative ə'pri:ʃiətɪv POS: a	a. 有欣赏力的, 感激的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. feeling or expressive of gratitude; s. having or showing appreciation or a favorable critical judgment or o...
envious 'enviəs POS: a	a. 嫉妒的, 羡慕的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. showing extreme cupidity; painfully desirous of another's advantages
hospitable 'hɒspɪəbl POS: a	a. 好客的, 招待周到的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. favorable to life and growth; a. disposed to treat guests and strangers with cordiality and generosity; s. h...
ripen 'raɪpən POS: vt	vt. 使成熟; vi. 成熟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to ripen or develop fully; v. grow ripe
merciful 'me:sɪfəl POS: a	a. 仁慈的, 慈悲的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. showing or giving mercy; s. (used conventionally of royalty and high nobility) gracious
sorrowful 'sɒrəʊfəl POS: a	a. 悲伤的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. experiencing or marked by or expressing sorrow especially that associated with irreparable loss